



şifr (*n., arabic*) — zero; the void; the origin of mathematics.

cipher (*n., cryptography*) — a code; a way of encoding meaning.

cypher (*n., music*) — a circle of voices in sequence.

**cyph (*n.*) — the new underground for ideas.**

# founders

## jalen daniels



- philosopher
- technologist
- strategist



alma mater  
harvard

previous work  
ex-mckinsey

- startup growth
- institution building
- public intellectual
- inbox 0
- classical ballet

researching  
transhumanism · nietzsche · urban agriculture

## bryan cash



- computer scientist
- sports savant
- optimizer



alma mater  
syracuse

previous work  
ex-washington post

- enterprise apps
- design engineering
- big data
- bowling
- chess

researching  
technofeudalism · neuroathletics · molecular gastronomy



**bakari kitwana**  
ex-eic of the source magazine



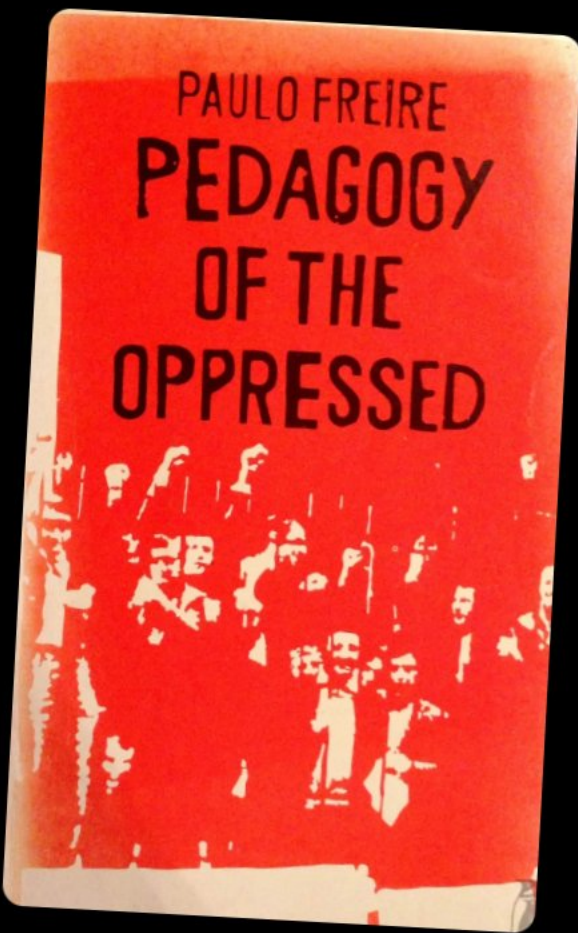
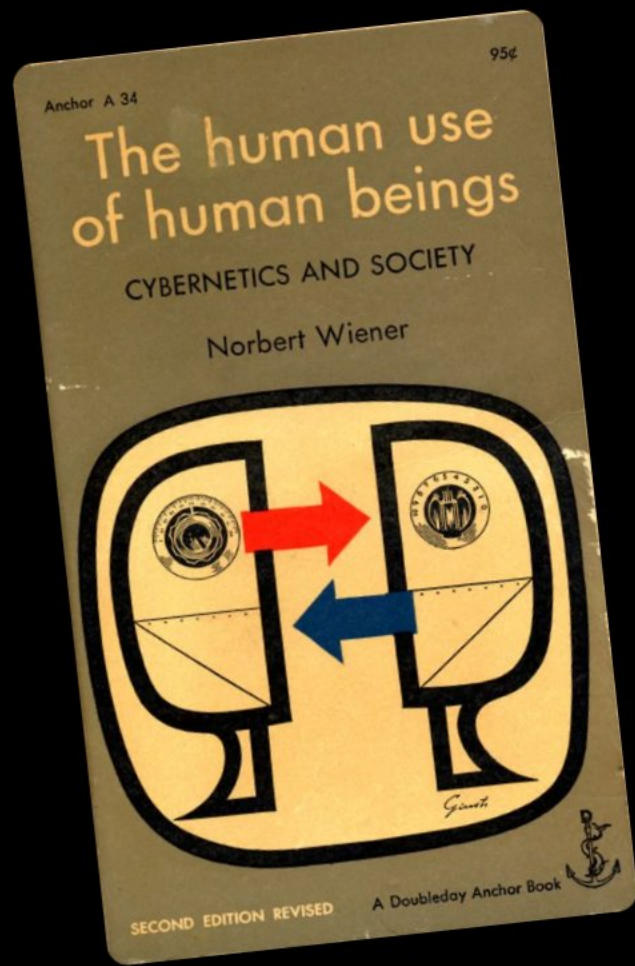
**caitlin begg**  
ceo of authentic social and return to analog podcast



**calvary rogers**  
ex-google, founder of seneca labs

advisory board

we're in an epistemic crisis.



ai → cognitive resignation

"your brain on chatgpt: accumulation of cognitive debt"



'veritas' is threatened

"college professors say their academic freedom is in decline"



monopolized knowledge

"anthropic destroyed millions of rare books to train their models"



but every epistemic crisis always had an underground.



### the agora

*athens, 500 bc*

where free thought had a home before the academy existed.



### the salon

*paris, 1700s*

where conversations that built the enlightenment happened in living rooms.



### harlem renaissance

*new york, 1920s*

where Black intellectuals made space for possibility in the midst of danger.

# cyph is the first underground for human wisdom in the digital age

type of person

## seekers

people who are not satisfied with the first answer.

size benchmark

1.5B+

monthly unique devices  
W

digital tools used



## sparrers

people who want to test ideas with real people.

500M+

weekly users in discussion  
reddit



## authorities

people with domain authority who distribute their ideas.

30M+

paid memberships  
|●≡



key insights

people crave verified, human-made material.

76% need to know if it's human-made 🌟

AI labs scanned millions of pre-AI books to train on WP

people want to unlock their inner scholar.

the AI age will reward people who choose mental effort A

knowledge is the new clout: 2.5M+ follow 2-hour lectures on Plato and history  
SSENSE

people want to think together, not in isolation.

+31% book club & "salon" events NBC NEWS

people crave masters, not influencers.

47% call influencers a top misinfo source 🌐

bookish creators lead the anti-slop wave VOGUE

where seekers, sparrers and authorities contest ideas together.

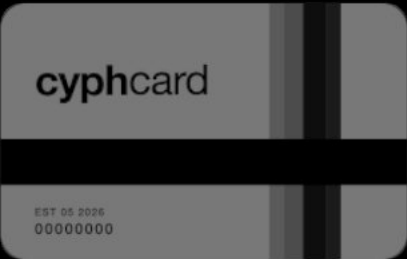
as AI fills the internet, human wisdom is becoming the scarcest asset.



welcome to cyph city.

[see trailer here](#)

user journey



01  
underground

where you become intellectually dangerous.

uncover a living world of buried artifacts, rare books, and suppressed ideas — all human made.\*

publish your own 'routes' to intellectual destinations.

teach a cohort learning sesh based on syllabi you design.



the nietzsche route

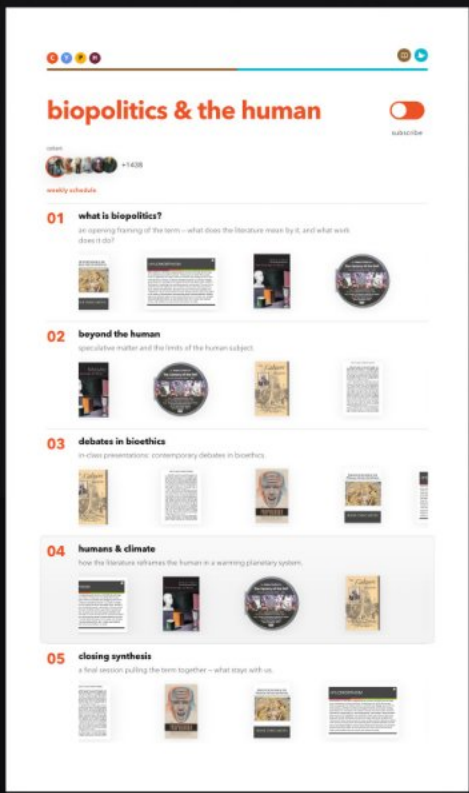
📖 25 stops

the athlete as activist

⊕ 21 stops

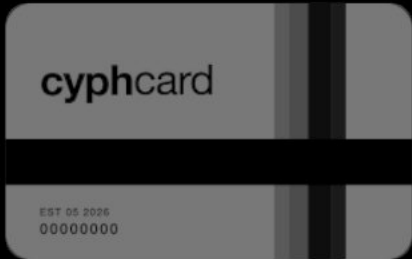
silence as composition

🎵 11 stops



\*seeded from open source, institutional, and personal collections.

user journey



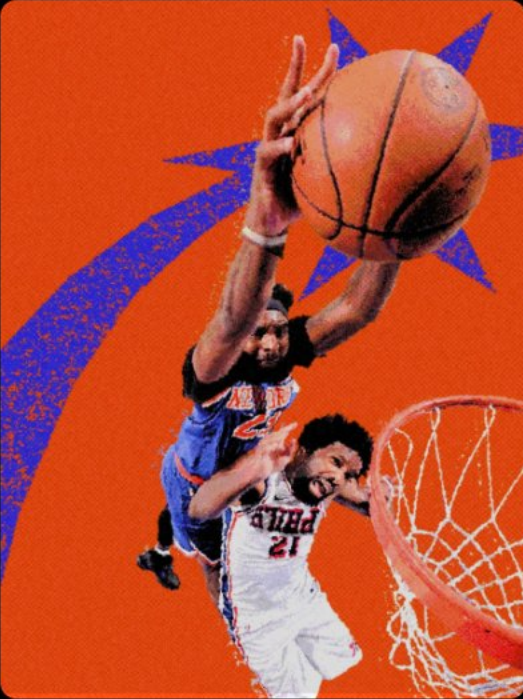
02  
the cyph

where ideas get tested in real time.

spark with thinkers around the world in real time. go deeper in office hours with underground scholars.

live

topics sourced from API's & real-time listening.



knicks championship



hosted by chris robinson

conceptual

ideas surfaced from pulses in deep research.

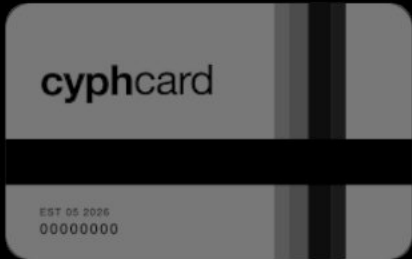


is the soul actually cartesian?



hosted by iain mcgilchrist

user journey

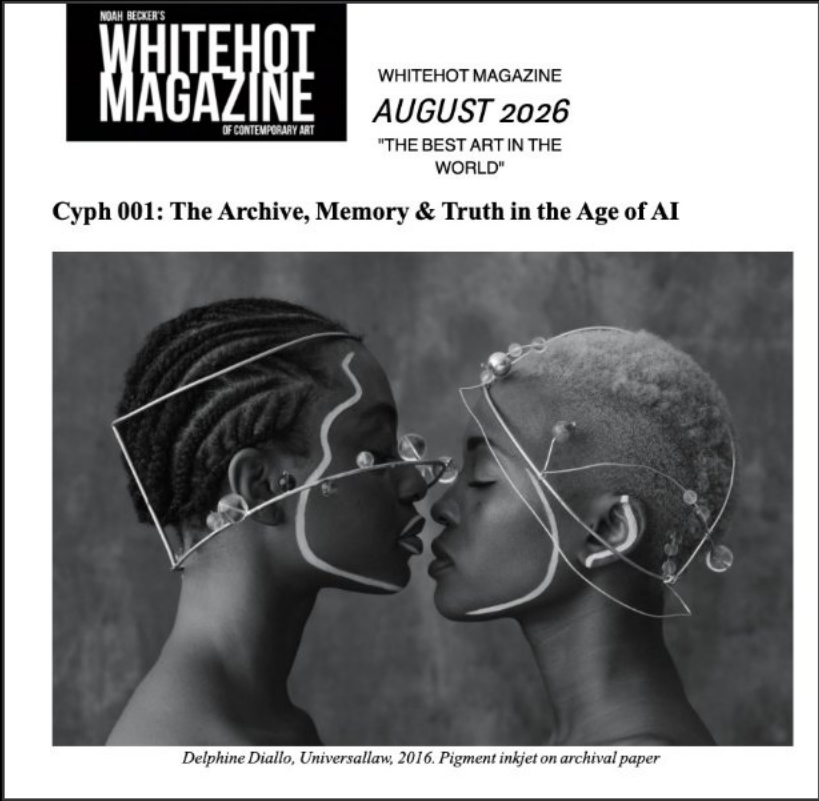


03

irl

close the laptop and enter our world of IRL cyphs: lectures, office hours, supper clubs, & debates. the research from the room is archived in our partner libraries.

our last cyph...



in the room



10+

residential libraries in nyc where cyph members can check out books.

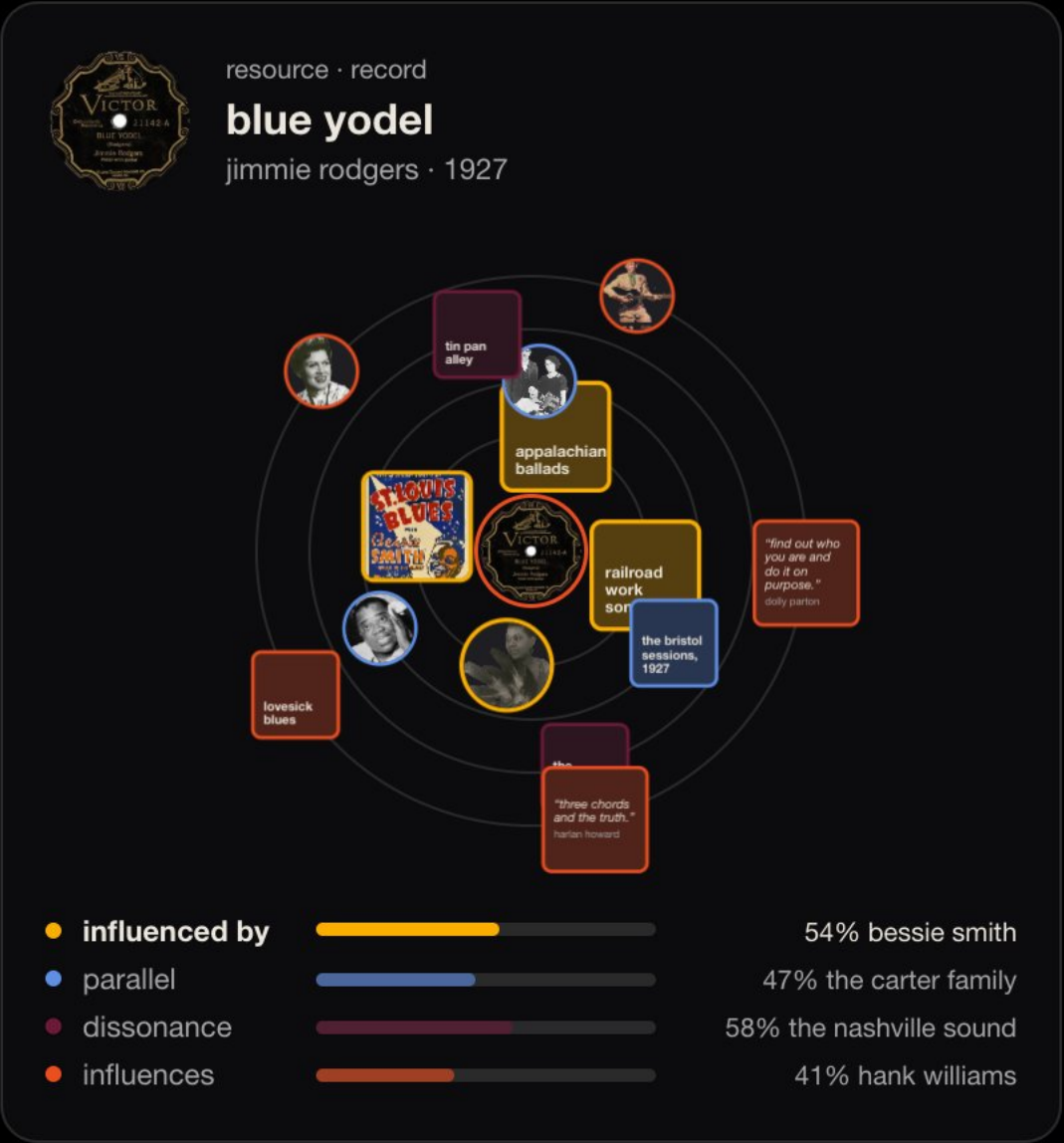
user journey



# 04

## how it all maps together

everything on cyph has its own dna. map the influence, and intersections of your ideas over time with the cyphcard.



traction.

150+

office hour leads

e.g., ex-professors, street scholars, domain masters



what cyph unlocks for them

revenue, authority, expanded audience

what they unlock for cyph

credibility, built-in audiences

500+

seeded partners

e.g., open-source archives, museums, libraries, universities



foot traffic, citations, conversions

verified sources, institutional trust

11K+

artifacts from personal collections

e.g., estates, family archives



discovery, legacy, wealth generation

exclusive inventory, a moat AI can't copy

# how we make money.

cyph.edu

universities pay for a campus underground shared with peer institutions of choice.

think *jstor meets early facebook*

unlock *scholarship for the everyday citizen, and campuses thinking out loud together again.*



cyphcard+

members pay annually for unlimited cohorts and rare perks, like residential libraries.

think *the met annual membership meets unlimited masterclass*

unlock *membership in an underground intelligentsia, that rewards you for being curious*

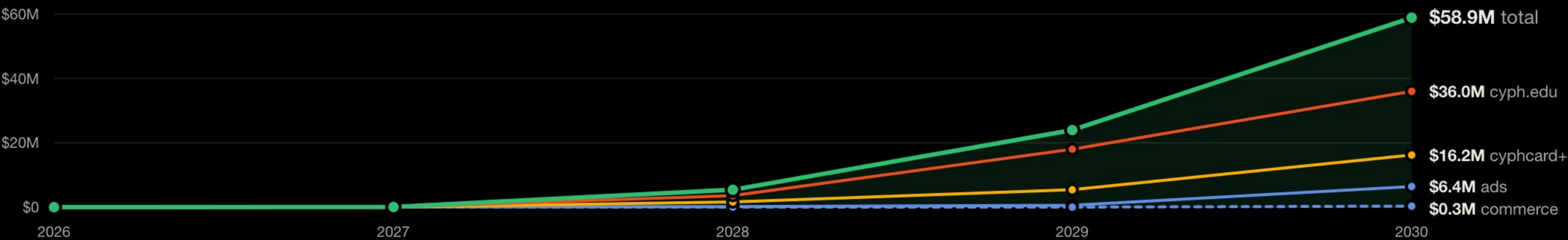


ads + commerce

partners pay for placements across cyph city, and we take a cut of each conversion.

think *pinterest's discovery, wirecutter's economics.*

unlock *integrated ads endorsed by the first digital underground*



cyph scales to ~\$59M revenue by 2030 at ~73.4% gross margins...while keeping wisdom free for every user.

projections available upon request.

build irl community while testing with icp, launch by invitation.

## what real people have said.

*"people are yearning to break the shackles and speak their truth."*

*"it encourages individuality...there's no need for an echo chamber."*

*"i like that it's centered around topics and things that matter rather than a sea of content."*

*"i love cyph because i can find actual scholars whom i would want to talk with."*

*"humanity needs a platform that tells them to go outside."*

*"the internet was built to enable resource sharing and open communication, not to suppress them."*

*"the world needs an ed-tech platform built by someone who knows how to resonate with culture."*

*"this feels like a breath of fresh air. online today is extremely gimmicky."*

the raise.

\$1.25M

raising

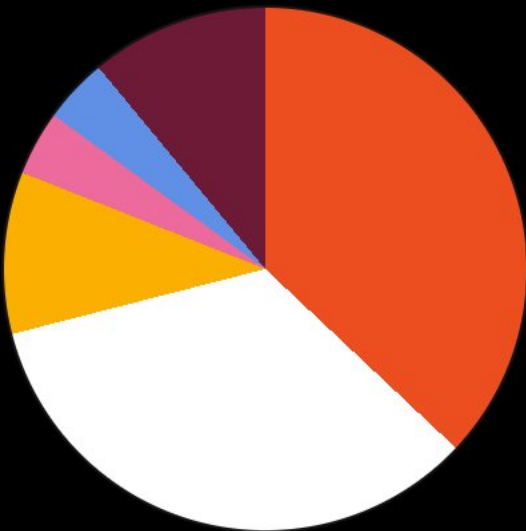
\$11.25M

pre-money cap

15 mo

runway

use of funds



- 37%

ops team  
3 FTEs: Jalen Daniels, Activation Lead, Library Scientist  
Activation Lead events, social media  
Library Scientist archival oversight, curation
- 34%

eng team  
2 FTEs: Bryan Cash, Creative Technologist, SWE Contract Fund  
Creative Technologist principal engineer, specializing in video game design.
- 10%

marketing & IRL
- 4%

overhead
- 4%

tech infra
- 11%

contingency

detailed model available upon request.

# ready for a demo?

[jalen@cyph.city](mailto:jalen@cyph.city) | [bryan@cyph.city](mailto:bryan@cyph.city)

## why us



**jalen  
daniels**

I'm a native New Yorker and former classical ballerina. I trained for 14+ years and have performed everywhere from the Apollo Theater to the Supreme Court and the White House. At Harvard, I honed my intellectual edge through a dual honors concentration in Social Studies and African American Studies. My summa award-winning thesis, "Enemies of The New: Transhumanism, Blackness, and Fleshless Imaginaries," intervenes in the evolving conversation on race, humanity, and technology and is now moving toward publication.

After college, I worked at McKinsey & Co., focusing on entertainment, Web3/Crypto, and economic mobility; I ended my time working on the Firm's first documentary film that premiered at Martha's Vineyard Film Festival. I then served as Chief of Staff at an art and technology startup, which had partnerships with Sotheby's, OpenAI, the Brooklyn Museum, Spotify, and more.

Today, my work sits at the intersection of culture, ideas, and institutional imagination. I serve as the youngest Trustee in the history of the Harvard Club of New York City, where I focus on revitalizing innovation and bringing world-class speakers with provoking ideas. I am grateful to be the Strategic Lead of an emerging private school in Houston (\$65M raise) with a rich curriculum in Black Diasporic identity and theology. I have advised copious Fortune 500 companies, and I am a consultant on some of the most exciting brands, including some stealth startups started by ex TIME and GQ executives. In my free time, I host public speaking engagements on technology, theology, and philosophy.

## why us



**bryan  
cash**

I'm a born-and-raised New Yorker and lifelong sports junkie—a kid from Jamaica, Queens who was obsessed with box scores, improbable correlations, and the energy of people. I've always seen the world through data long before it was a buzzword. I was the kid fascinated by how fast the NBA could aggregate Dwyane Wade's performance based on Gabrielle Union's attendance. That curiosity is what led me to study Computer Science at Syracuse. I wanted to help businesses uncover deep analytics that unlock real storytelling.

My career has always lived at the intersection of data and real-world impact. I audited multi-billion-dollar settlements, including the Volkswagen emissions scandal; rebuilt the analytics backbone for The Washington Post's Publishing & Circulation team; and helped scale Vantage Risk's Political, Risk & Credit unit from \$70M to over \$225M in Gross Written Premium (GWP), contributing to the firm surpassing \$1B+ GWP. While compelled by the power of data across these experiences, I wanted to bring my technology journey full circle and build platforms with cultural resonance.

I created my own sports analytics company, delivering proprietary data you couldn't find anywhere else. I then became CTO of an art and technology startup, which had partnerships with major institutions such as Sotheby's, Spotify, OpenAI, the Brooklyn Museum, and more.

Today, my work blends engineering rigor with cultural intuition, and is always driven by the belief that technology should amplify our humanity, not replace it. That's why we started Cyph.